

Antonio Carmagnani

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Dear Hiring Team at EY,

I trained as an architect, but the part of the work that held my attention was the step before the drawings, deciding what a site was worth and what could justifiably be built on it. Alongside architecture I kept two interests running, the market side of real estate and data, and I moved from Brazil to Copenhagen for an M.Arch in Architecture Computation at The Royal Danish Academy to bring them together. The Valuation in Assurance team is where that points now, because a valuation read in the context of financial reporting has to survive scrutiny rather than simply look reasonable.

As a trainee in real estate product development at OSPA I produced more than fifteen feasibility studies for mixed-use and residential developments across São Paulo, Rio de Janeiro, Porto Alegre and Miami, sizing investment and return against buildable area, unit mix, price per square metre and parking. Each study came down to a small set of assumptions, and the demanding part of the job was defending them in front of developers who had their own reading of the market. It is the residual method in practice, and it taught me that the number matters less than whether the reasoning underneath it holds.

The reviewing side came from Itaú-Unibanco, where I checked technical documentation on the bank's real estate as a compliance gate before construction was authorised, and assessed the environmental and energy performance of buildings the bank was acquiring or leasing. More recently I built a property valuation model using ensemble methods (XGBoost, LightGBM, CatBoost) on structured property and financial data, finishing in the top two percent of a competitive field. Building a valuation from the inside is what teaches you where someone else's assumptions are load-bearing.

EY trains this work against the RICS Red Book, IVS and IFRS 13, and that formal grounding is the piece my experience does not yet have.

All the best,

Antonio Carmagnani